

Illinois Hazard Mitigation Plan Update Assistant - Senior Brief

Generated: July 07, 2026

Purpose

This brief summarizes a GIS-enabled data assistant developed to support review and update work for the Illinois Natural Hazard Mitigation Plan. The assistant focuses on Chapter 1 Census table updates, regional vulnerability comparison, GIS mapping, exploratory statistical analysis, and review tracking for goals, attendees, mitigation actions, and critical facilities.

Current Automated Outputs

Module	Current Function
Census Update	Pulls ACS county-level data and aggregates it into the four mitigation planning regions.
2021 vs Latest	Compares plan baseline values against the latest ACS regional aggregation.
GIS Map	Displays an Illinois county choropleth map using vulnerability indicators and a prototype priority score.
Regression Lab	Shows exploratory relationships such as poverty rate versus older adult population share.
Plan Review	Tracks review areas: goals, attendees, action relevancy, critical facilities, and Chapter 1 Census updates.

2021 Plan Baseline vs Latest ACS Regional Comparison

Region	total_population_2021	total_population	population_change	population_pct_change	poverty_rate_2021	poverty_rate	poverty_rate_pp_change	vacancy_rate_2021	vacancy_rate	vacancy_rate_pp_change
Northwest	849604	838801	-10803	-1.27	13.7	13.5	-0.2	10.5	9.51	-0.99
Central	1675008	1728556	53548	3.2	14.0	13.78	-0.22	10.9	9.5	-1.4
Southern	1301700	1282769	-18931	-1.45	13.7	13.28	-0.42	12.9	12.18	-0.72

Top 15 Counties by Prototype Mitigation Priority Score

county_name	region	total_population	poverty_rate	age_65_plus_rate	vacancy_rate	bachelors_or_higher_rate	prototype_priority_score
Pulaski	Southern	5015	24.98	23.37	31.95	13.0	82.8
Alexander	Southern	4875	19.02	24.92	35.19	12.55	79.56
Pope	Southern	3739	13.31	28.99	37.75	15.67	77.32
Hardin	Southern	3605	10.96	29.85	33.89	13.28	74.83
Schuyler	Central	6787	20.77	25.7	17.3	19.07	68.35
Calhoun	Southern	4330	6.31	25.43	46.13	20.12	65.77
Henderson	Northwest	6193	13.94	27.61	19.67	20.64	62.72
Gallatin	Southern	4819	13.58	25.25	16.25	13.6	61.64
Johnson	Southern	13376	17.58	19.66	25.99	19.56	60.97
Massac	Southern	13865	16.27	21.99	20.01	17.05	60.61
Carroll	Northwest	15576	14.2	24.19	19.82	17.75	60.4
Union	Southern	16997	20.22	22.94	12.52	20.94	60.04
Clay	Southern	13052	17.51	20.89	13.85	13.1	59.67
White	Southern	13619	16.37	23.43	15.72	18.29	59.4
Edwards	Southern	6075	16.49	22.55	12.45	13.95	59.26

Interpretation Note

The prototype mitigation priority score is a decision-support index created from selected ACS indicators, including poverty, older adult population share, housing vacancy, and educational attainment. It is not an official FEMA or IEMA-OHS score. It is intended to help identify counties where social vulnerability indicators may warrant closer review alongside hazard exposure, critical facilities, and local mitigation priorities.

Feedback Requested

Review Area	Feedback Requested
County-to-region list	Confirm whether the county assignments reflect the official mitigation planning regions.
Census update	Confirm whether ACS 2024 should be used, or whether another Census/ACS year is preferred.
Critical facilities	Identify preferred internal datasets for facilities, shelters, hospitals, state assets, and lifelines.
Goals/actions	Advise whether goal and action review should follow a specific IEMA-OHS or FEMA crosswalk format.

GIS outputs	Advise whether the map should include additional layers such as hazards, repetitive loss, shelters, or state facilities.
-------------	--